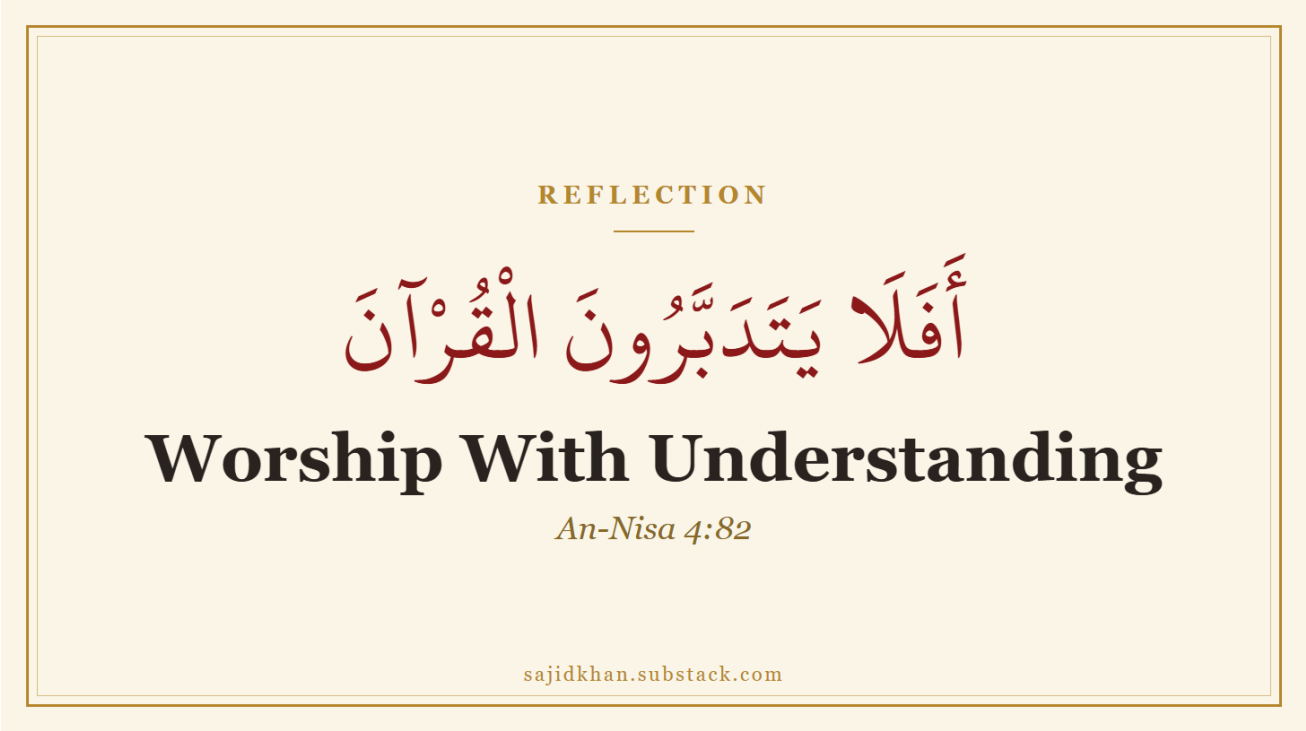


REFLECTION

Worship With Understanding

A saying of 'Ali on reading without reflecting

A well-known saying is reported from 'Ali ibn Abi Talib, may Allah be pleased with him:

In Arabic: "أَلَا لَا خَيْرَ فِي عِبَادَةٍ لَيْسَ فِيهَا تَفَقُّهٌ۞ وَلَا عِلْمٍ لَيْسَ فِيهِ تَفَهُّمٌ۞ وَلَا قِرَاءَةٍ لَيْسَ فِيهَا تَدَبُّرٌ"

"Beware: there is no good in worship without understanding of the religion, nor in knowledge without real understanding, nor in reading without reflection." (Reported by ad-Darimi.)

Three key words

- **Understanding of the deen:** تَفَقُّه (*tafaqquh*), from the same root as *fiqh*.
- **Real understanding:** تَفَهُّم (*tafahhum*), working hard to grasp something.
- **Reflection:** تَدَبُّر (*tadabbur*), thinking about where a thing leads. Allah asks: أَفَلَا يَتَدَبَّرُونَ الْقُرْآنَ "Do they not reflect on the Qur'an?" (4:82).

Understand your deen and your worship, and think about what the Qur'an is saying to you. Learn Arabic, or at least read with a translation and stop to think. That is the way out of the difficulty our Ummah is in.

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